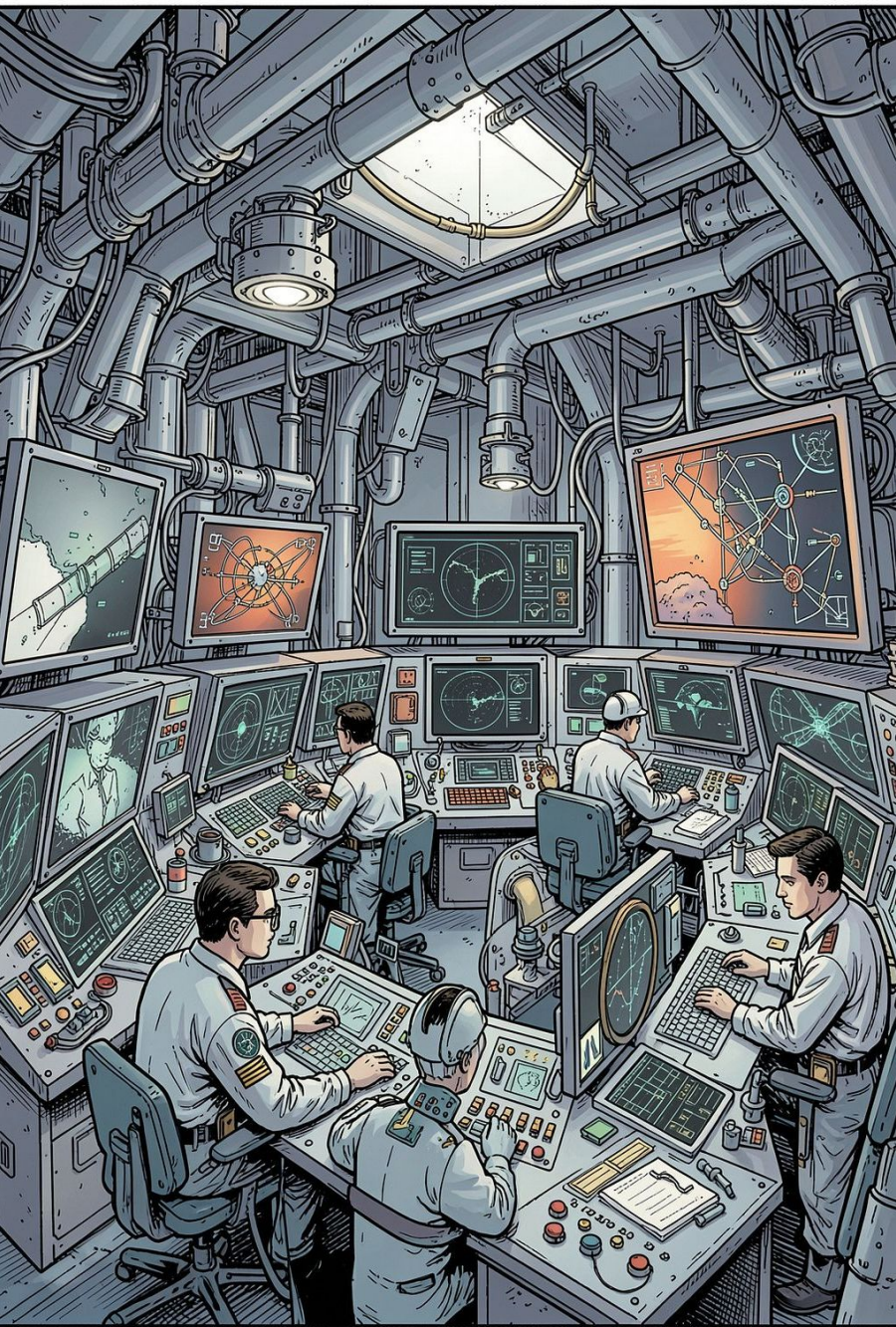


Dounreay Nuclear: PMO Service Review & Portfolio Management

An executive case study in governance, portfolio delivery, and strategic PMO leadership within a complex, regulated nuclear environment.





The Challenge

Dounreay presented a uniquely demanding operating environment — one that required a PMO capable of navigating complexity at every level.

Multi-Vendor Complexity

A layered service integrator model with multiple third-party vendors demanded precise coordination and clear accountability.

Stabilisation Imperative

The PMO service required rapid assessment, targeted stabilisation, and a credible path to strategic enhancement.

Regulated Environment

Nuclear sector standards demanded rigorous governance, delivery predictability, and uncompromising accountability.

Initial Service Review & Assessment



A Structured Approach to Baseline & Improvement

The engagement began with a rigorous, evidence-based review to establish a clear picture of PMO maturity and identify the most critical improvement levers.

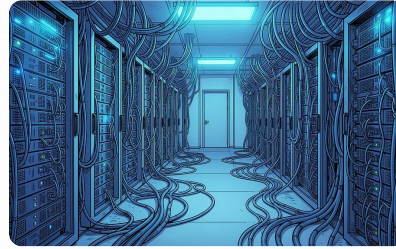
- 1 PMO Maturity Review**
Comprehensive gap analysis across governance, assurance, and delivery processes.
- 2 Vendor Coordination Findings**
Identified specific weaknesses in multi-vendor oversight and coordination mechanisms.
- 3 Improvement Roadmap**
Delivered an actionable, prioritised roadmap presented directly to senior leadership.

Portfolio Management & Delivery



Engineering & Infrastructure

Managed concurrent delivery across engineering and infrastructure workstreams with disciplined schedule and risk oversight.



IT Portfolio Governance

Established transparent performance reporting and governance rhythms across technology projects.



Vendor & Integrator Coordination

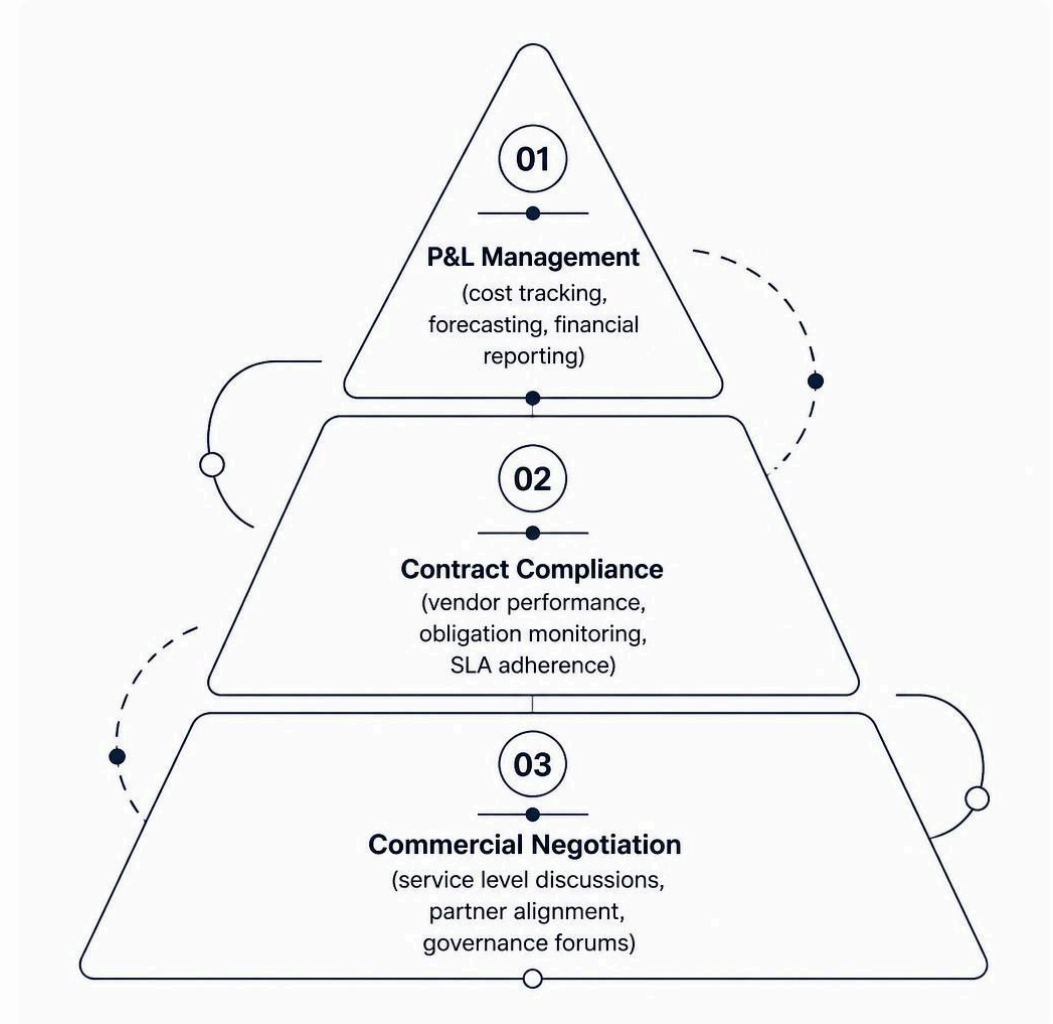
Coordinated with the service integrator and third-party vendors to maintain alignment and delivery predictability.

Financial & Commercial Management

Commercial Rigour Underpinning Delivery

Effective PMO leadership at Dounreay required more than schedule and risk management – it demanded full commercial ownership of the service.

- **P&L Ownership:** Active cost-tracking and rolling forecasting mechanisms maintained financial transparency throughout.
- **Contract Compliance:** Ensured all vendor contracts remained aligned to performance obligations and commercial terms.
- **Commercial Negotiations:** Provided direct support to service-level negotiations and commercial governance forums.



Leadership & Team Development

Capability Building

Built a cohesive, high-performing PMO team through structured mentoring, coaching, and targeted capability development.

Culture of Excellence

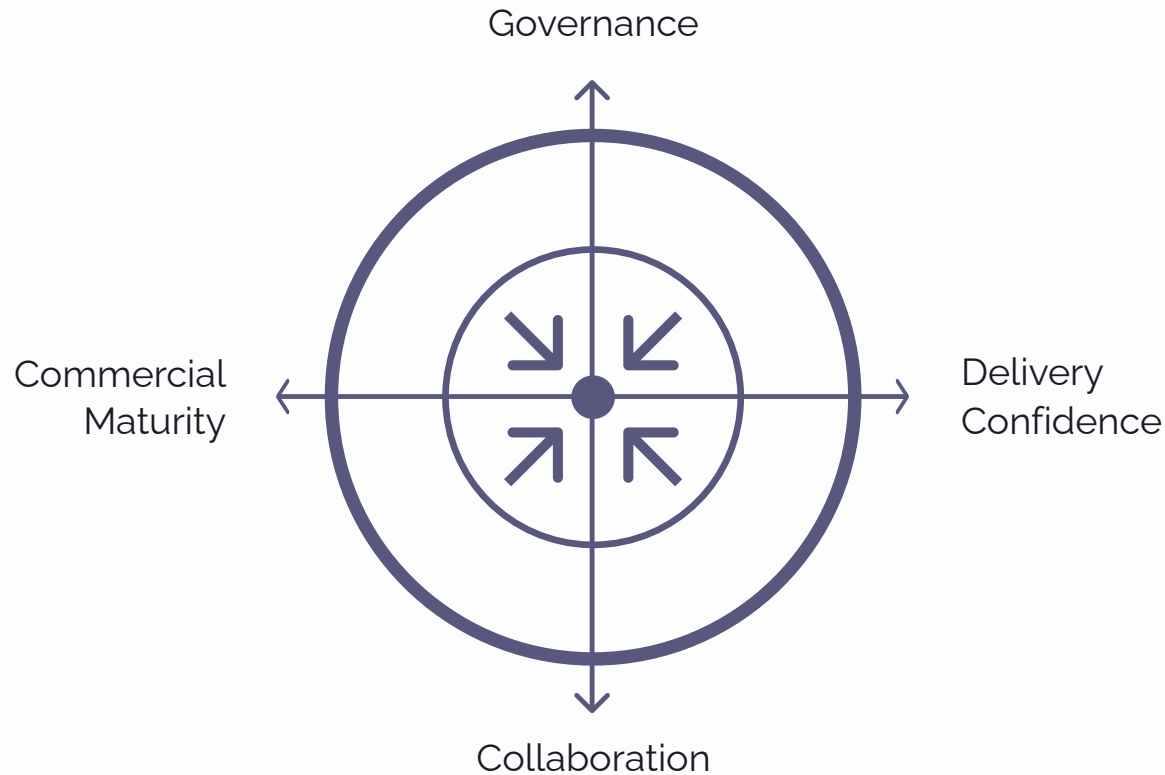
Embedded a shared culture of collaboration, accountability, and delivery excellence across the team.

Stakeholder Alignment

Kept the team oriented to organisational priorities and responsive to evolving stakeholder expectations.



Strategic Impact



A Materially Improved PMO Service

The cumulative effect of disciplined assessment, structured delivery, and commercial leadership delivered outcomes that extended well beyond operational efficiency.

- A mature, commercially aware PMO operating at the level demanded by complex portfolio management.
- Measurably strengthened governance frameworks and improved confidence in delivery outcomes.
- Deeper, more productive collaboration across internal teams and external delivery partners.

Key Takeaway

A disciplined, strategically aligned PMO transforms portfolio delivery in complex, multi-vendor environments — particularly critical in regulated industries where governance and accountability are paramount.



Governance First

In regulated environments, governance is not overhead — it is the foundation of delivery confidence.



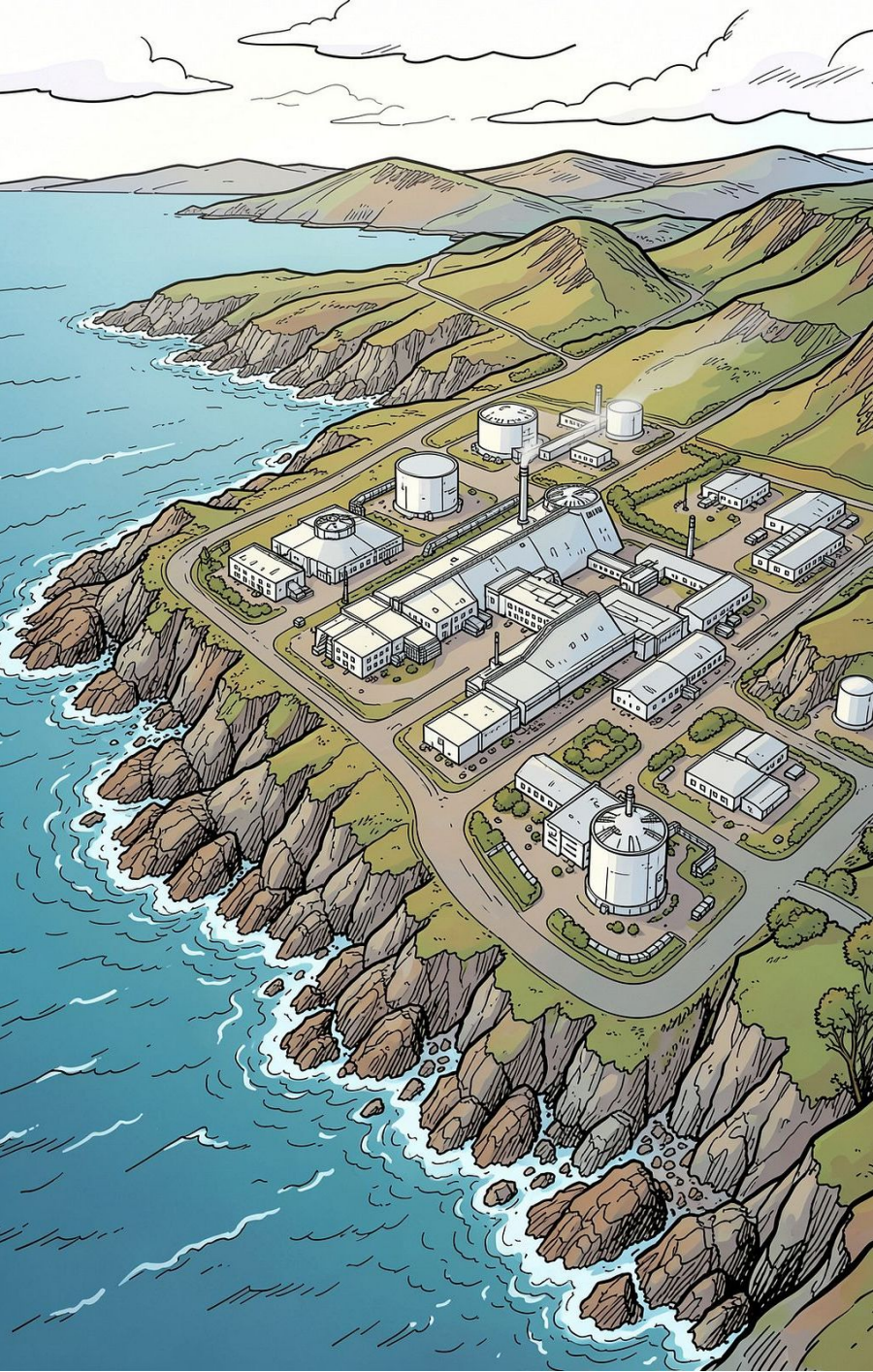
Vendor Complexity Demands Structure

Multi-vendor models require deliberate coordination frameworks, not informal relationships.



Commercial Awareness is a PMO Competency

P&L literacy and contract fluency are essential capabilities for senior PMO leadership.



Dounreay Nuclear PMO

A case study in **governance, commercial stewardship, and delivery leadership** within one of the UK's most complex regulated project environments.

Service Review

Maturity assessment & gap analysis

Portfolio Delivery

Multi-domain concurrent management

Financial Control

P&L ownership & commercial governance

Team Leadership

Capability development & culture